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8/29/26

IS 4487

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IS 4487 – Personalized Learning Outcomes SubmissionTwo New Learning Outcomes

1. Use Python to clean, visualize, and run basic models on financial and operating data so I can identify performance drivers, build simple forecasts, and support budgeting or investment decisions I would have to defend as a finance major heading toward corporate finance or FP&A.
2. Translate those results into recommendations a finance team could use, connecting the analysis to profitability, risk, and resource allocation while checking assumptions, biased inputs, and the ethical use of financial and customer-linked data.

These are relevant because they keep the course skills—Python, problem framing, visualization, basic modeling, communication, and ethics—and apply them to finance instead of generic business cases.

Reflection: The two outcomes above are the ones I created for this course. I started by reviewing the syllabus. The official outcomes already cover Python, the analytics process, wrangling and visualization, framing a problem, communicating results, and ethical data use. What they do not do is show how those skills look in finance. That was the gap I needed to close. I opened the Tutoring Bot with “Help me customize my learning outcomes.” It asked about my major, career goals, why I took the class, the problems I care about, and my background. I said I am a Finance major and that I want to move toward corporate finance, FP&A, or a finance manager track. I took Business Analytics because finance work is no longer just statements and Excel summaries. I need to handle larger datasets, see what is driving results, and explain what that means for budget, forecast, and risk. I have used Excel and financial statements. Python is still new. The problems I keep coming back to are forecasting, variance analysis,

profitability, and deciding where capital should go. The first drafts were not strong enough. One was too broad: “use analytics to support finance decisions.” That is true, but it is not something I could point back to on a later assignment. The next draft went too far and sounded like I was already building advanced risk models or trading algorithms. That is not this class, and it is not the work I am preparing for. What did not work was accepting those versions as finished. What did work was telling the Bot to stay inside IS 4487 and only change the setting. I asked for a first outcome with a real finance action, not just “analyze data.” I asked for a second outcome that sounded like something I would present to a controller, CFO, or department head, including risk and ethics. After two revisions, the direction was right. I then rewrote the wording so it sounded like me. The Bot helped me narrow the idea. I still had to make the language usable. These outcomes matter to my major because finance is moving toward evidence, not just reporting what already happened. I can read a statement and talk about margin or cash in general terms. What I cannot do yet is take messy financial or operating data, clean it in Python, visualize the drivers, and support a forecast or budget recommendation without guessing. That is the skill I need if I want to be more than someone who updates a spreadsheet. They also matter to my career plans because a finance role is judged on whether the recommendation holds up. If I recommend cutting a budget, funding a project, or changing a forecast, I need to show the analysis and the limits of the analysis. The ethics piece matters too. Financial data is not neutral when it includes customer behavior, credit information, or assumptions that quietly favor one group or one outcome. I want to be able to say what the model shows and whether we should trust it. For the rest of the semester I am going to use these two outcomes as a filter. If I am wrangling or modeling, I will ask whether the work helps me explain performance or support a financial decision. If I am writing or presenting, I will ask whether a finance manager could act on it and whether I addressed the assumptions and ethical issues. That is how I plan to keep this course connected to my major.

Conversation with the Tutoring Bot
Student: Help me customize my learning outcomes.
Bot: I can help you adapt the course outcomes to your goals. What's your major, or what fields are you considering? What are your career interests? Why did you take this course? Are there specific industries or problems you care about? What experience do you already have with data or programming?
ME: Finance major. I want to go into corporate finance, FP&A, or eventually a finance manager role. I took this class because finance jobs expect more data skill than just Excel. I'm interested in forecasting, variance analysis, profitability, and resource allocation. I've used Excel and financial statements. Python is still new.
Bot: Here are two first drafts:

1. Use Python to clean and visualize financial data in order to support finance decisions.
2. Communicate analytic findings to finance stakeholders and consider ethical issues in data use.

Do you want these more specific?
ME: The first one is too vague. It doesn't say what I would actually do with the analysis. Add basic modeling and a real finance action, like forecasting, budgeting, or investment support. The second one sounds like a syllabus line. I need it to sound like something I would present to a finance manager, including risk, assumptions, and ethics. Keep it at this course's level.
Bot: Updated versions:

1. Apply Python-based data wrangling, visualization, and basic predictive modeling to financial and operating datasets so I can identify performance drivers, build simple forecasts, and recommend budgeting or investment decisions.
2. Translate analytic results into clear recommendations for finance stakeholders, connecting model outputs to profitability, risk, and resource allocation while addressing assumptions, bias, and ethical use of financial data.

ME: That's the right direction. I'm going to rewrite them so they sound like me, but I'm keeping this split: one outcome for doing the analysis, one for explaining it and dealing with risk and ethics. Bot: That split works. Keep both visible for later assignments so you can show how each deliverable connects back to your own outcomes.